

Skill & Product Library / RevOps

Automation Workflow

Live in production

Partner PQL Automation

AI lead classification & routing — genuine partnership leads reach a human; vendor spam never does.



Live — AI-drafted responses reach only genuine leads; vendor spam filtered with zero manual triage

n8n

Azure OpenAI

HubSpot

lead routing

classification

Overview

A global HR-tech (EOR) platform's partner-inquiry form mixed genuine partnership leads (referral, alliance, integration) with vendor spam, and everything landed on one person to triage by hand. This webhook-triggered n8n workflow classifies every submission with an enterprise LLM, stamps CRM properties and lifecycle stage, creates a high-priority task with an AI-drafted response for the partnerships owner on real leads — and politely filters vendor pitches with no task and no email, so a human's attention is spent only where it matters.

The Problem

Partner-form submissions on the company website mixed real partnership opportunities with vendor pitches (agencies, tool sellers, cold outreach disguised as "partnership inquiries"). Every submission funneled to one person to manually read, classify, and respond to — a bottleneck that also meant real leads sometimes waited behind spam.

How It Works

1. **Webhook trigger** — the partner-inquiry form POSTs directly into n8n (a workflow-automation platform) the moment it's submitted, no polling delay.
2. **AI classification** — an enterprise LLM reads the submission and classifies partner type: referral, alliance, integration, or vendor pitch — the four buckets that determine what happens next.
3. **CRM stamping** — properties and lifecycle stage are written to the associated contact/company record via the CRM API, so the classification lives on the record permanently, not just in an email.
4. **Routing on genuine leads** — for referral/alliance/integration leads, a high-priority task is created and assigned to the partnerships owner, paired with an AI-drafted first-response email ready to send or edit.
5. **Silent filtering on vendor spam** — pitches classified as vendor spam get no task and no email — filtered politely with zero human time spent, rather than dumped in someone's queue.
6. **Shared error handling** — the workflow is wired into the team's standard shared error-handler workflow, so a failure here surfaces the same way every other automation's failures do (not a silent, one-off gap).



Stack & Integrations

Tool	Role	Access needed
n8n	Webhook trigger + orchestration	n8n workspace, webhook enabled
Enterprise LLM (Azure OpenAI)	Partner-type classification + AI-drafted response generation	Deployment + API credential
CRM API (HubSpot)	Contact/company properties, lifecycle stage, task creation, owner routing	Private-app token (contacts/companies read-write, tasks, owners)
Shared error-handler workflow	Standardized failure alerting across the automation stack	Internal n8n workflow reference

Setup Process

1. Import the workflow JSON into n8n; bind LLM and CRM credentials.
2. Point the partner-inquiry form's webhook at the n8n trigger URL.
3. Create/confirm the CRM properties the workflow stamps (partner type, lifecycle stage) and the task-owner assignment rule.
4. Wire the workflow into the shared error-handler pattern used across the automation stack.
5. Run the three included test payloads (valid partner, vendor spam, alliance) to confirm expected behavior before the form goes live.

6. Activate; monitor the first week of live submissions against the classification.

What You Need

- [] n8n workspace with webhooks enabled
- [] Enterprise LLM deployment + API credential
- [] CRM private-app token (contacts/companies read-write, tasks, owner routing)
- [] A defined partnerships owner to route tasks to
- [] ~2–3 hours to deploy and test against sample payloads

Results

- **Live in production.** High-priority tasks with AI-drafted responses reach the partnerships owner only for genuine partnership leads; vendor pitches are filtered with zero manual triage.
- Shipped with three curl test payloads (valid partner / vendor spam / alliance) that defined expected behavior *before* the form went live — test-first deployment.
- Fixed a CRM API version-mismatch bug pre-launch that would have silently created tasks with no contact attached.



Challenges & Fixes

- **CRM API version change (an internal ID field renamed)** → would have silently created orphaned tasks (no contact attached) → caught and fixed in the deploy guide before go-live.
- **Node reordering risk breaking references** → hardened node references so the workflow survives being rearranged during future edits.
- **No test coverage for a form that hadn't launched yet** → three curl payloads (valid partner / vendor spam / alliance) authored to define and verify expected behavior before real traffic arrived.
- **Failures needing a consistent alerting path** → wired into the team's shared error-handler workflow instead of a one-off try/catch.

Demonstrates

LLM classification in a production CRM path · defensive integration coding (catching an API version mismatch before it silently corrupted data) · test-first deployment discipline.

STACK & INTEGRATIONS

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DISCUSS THIS BUILD

Happy to walk through the architecture, the failures along the way, or how this could translate to your team.

Email Patrick



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